

# Frederik Weber Henriksen

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## Research Profile

My research investigates how digital information environments — particularly alternative news media and anti-systemic counterpublics — reshape democratic opinion formation, polarization, and climate issues. I study these phenomena using digital methods, combining computational approaches (NLP, network analysis, automated classification) with surveys, data donations, and qualitative methods in mixed-methods designs.

## Employment

### **2025–2028 Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University**

- Researcher on (1) the Carlsberg-funded AlterPublics project (Alternative media & ideological counterpublics) and (2) the Independent Research Fund Denmark-funded #Echopol project (Polarisation dynamics & digital echo chambers).
- Develop research designs combining digital trace data, computational text analysis (NLP), network analysis, survey data, data donations, and agent-based models.

### **2024 Research Assistant, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University**

- AlterPublics project: digital data collection and research design for the Nordic Alternative Media Observatory; contributed to manuscripts and conference dissemination.

### **2020–2021 Research Assistant, iCourts (ERC JustSites), Faculty of Law, University of Copenhagen**

- Developed methodological framework and conducted quantitative analyses; built a large prosopographic dataset and coordinated student assistants and data specialists.

### **2020 Research Assistant, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University**

- VELUX-funded COVID-19/green transition project: survey design, recruitment, analysis, and reporting.

### **2019–2020 Teaching Assistant (30 hours/week), DTU**

- Taught seminars and supported course delivery: Theory of Science for Engineers (ethics, SDGs, scientific knowledge production).

### **2019 Student Assistant (15 hours/week), City of Copenhagen**

- Mixed-method evaluation: 30 interviews + web survey; authored municipal report on civic green initiatives.

### **2017–2019 Student Assistant (12 hours/week), Department of Learning and Philosophy, AAU**

- Supported mixed-method research (MCA, surveys, interviews) and workshop organisation; team output included two peer-reviewed articles.

## Education

## **2024 PhD in Media and Communication Science, Roskilde University**

- Article-based dissertation: "Burn it down — Anti-Systemic Narratives and Counterpublics in Digital Alternative Information Environments" (part of the Carlsberg-funded AlterPublics project).

## **2020 MA in Sociology (cand.scient.soc.), University of Copenhagen**

- Specialisation in political sociology.

## **2017 BA in Sociology, University of Copenhagen**

## **2015 BA in Philosophy, University of Copenhagen**

## **2015 Exchange study, University of British Columbia**

## **Research Stays**

### **2023 Computational Communication Science Lab, University of Vienna**

3 months; host: Prof. Annie Waldherr.

## **Teaching and Supervision**

- Supervision across Journalism, Communication, Social Sciences, and Humanities programmes at Roskilde University.
- 10+ BA semester projects (group-based, PPL format), 10+ MA projects (group and individual), and 1 completed MA thesis.
- Teaching Assistant, "Theory of Science for Engineers" (ethics, SDGs, scientific knowledge production), DTU, 2019–2020.

## **Publications**

### ***Peer-reviewed journal articles***

**2026** Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Climate obstruction in the digital far-right: Mapping the climate countermovement in German-, Danish-, and Swedish-speaking digital information environments.** *Environmental Communication*.  
[doi.org/10.1080/17524032.2026.2701866](https://doi.org/10.1080/17524032.2026.2701866)

**2026** Henriksen, F. M., Mayerhöffer, E., & Kristensen, J. B. **Crisis as opportunity? Far-right mobilisation in digital information environments during the COVID-19 pandemic.** *New Media & Society*. [doi.org/10.1177/14614448261443536](https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448261443536)

**2026** Henriksen, F. M. **RUCAI: An open-source, local-first AI teaching assistant for course planning and classroom support.** *Computational Humanities Research (Cambridge University Press)*.  
[doi.org/10.1017/chr.2026.10038](https://doi.org/10.1017/chr.2026.10038)

**2025** Grahm, H., Kalsnes, B., Isaksson, E., Mayerhöffer, E., Ólafsson, J. G., Falkheimer, J., Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Saari, D. **Mapping research on disinformation and misinformation across the Nordic countries: An integrative review.** *Nordicom Review*, 46(S1).  
[doi.org/10.2478/nor-2025-0015](https://doi.org/10.2478/nor-2025-0015)

**2024** Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Dissemination of RT and Sputnik content in European digital alternative news environments: Mapping the influence of Russian state-backed media across platforms, topics, and ideology.** *International Journal of Press/Politics*, 29(3), 795–818. [doi.org/10.1177/19401612241230281](https://doi.org/10.1177/19401612241230281)

**2024** Henriksen, F. M. **Anti-systemic counterpublics: Rethinking the counterpublic sphere.** *Javnost – The Public*, 31(2), 213–230. doi.org/10.1080/13183222.2024.2342219

**2023** Kristensen, J. B., Henriksen, F. M., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Did COVID-19 blur partisan boundaries? A comparison of partisan affinity and source heterophily in online alternative news-sharing networks before and during the pandemic.** *Social Media + Society*, 9(3). doi.org/10.1177/20563051231192963

**2022** Larsen, K., Hindhede, A. L., Larsen, M. H., Nicolaisen, M. H., & Henriksen, F. M. **Bodies need yoga? No plastic surgery! Naturalistic versus instrumental bodies among professions in the Danish healthcare field.** *Social Theory & Health*, 20(1). doi.org/10.1057/s41285-020-00151-z

**2020** Larsen, K., Hindhede, A. L., & Henriksen, F. M. **Sundhedskapital blandt danske sundhedsprofessionelle: En kvantitativ og kvalitativ undersøgelse af kropsopfattelser og distinktion blandt forskere, klinikere og studerende i Danmark.** *Praktiske Grunde: Nordisk tidsskrift for kultur- og samfundsvidenskab*.

#### **Book chapter (in press)**

**2026** Henriksen, F. M. **Mapping the margins: Building a cross-national observatory for alternative news media research.** In E. Mayerhöffer et al. (Eds.), *Alternative Media in European Contexts*. Palgrave Macmillan.

#### **Under review**

Henriksen, F. M. **Do generative large language models close the language gap in multilingual discourse classification?** *Computational Communication Research*.

Mayerhöffer, E., Pedersen, L., & Henriksen, F. M. **Alternative news use beyond (dis)trust: Linking alternative news orientation to citizens' struggles for recognition.** *Information, Communication & Society*.

Kakavand, A., Henriksen, F. M., Stecker, M., & Kathirgamalingam, A. **An evaluation of computational user identity linkage approaches: Matching far-right actors across social media platforms.** *Communication Methods and Measures*.

Sivertsen, M. F., & Henriksen, F. M. **Do tech professionals align with democratic norms?** *European Sociological Review*.

#### **Doctoral dissertation**

**2024** Henriksen, F. M. **Burn it down: Anti-Systemic Narratives and Counterpublics in Digital Alternative Information Environments.** *Doctoral dissertation, Roskilde University*.

#### **Data and web publications**

**2026** Henriksen, F. M., Mayerhöffer, E., & Kristensen, J. B. **Climate obstruction in the digital far-right: dataset.** figshare. doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.33054782

**2024** Henriksen, F. M. **Anti-systemic populism during the Covid-19 pandemic.** *Web publication, Roskilde University*.

**2024** Mayerhöffer, E., Henriksen, F. M., & Kristensen, J. B. **Digitale modoffentligheder på sociale medier.** *Web publication, Roskilde University*.

**2022** Ramsland, T., Henriksen, F. M., Kristensen, J. B., & Mayerhöffer, E. **Spredning af RT & Sputnik i alternative nyhedsmiljøer: Hvordan dansk-, svensk- og tysksprogede alternative nyhedsmiljøer deler indhold fra russiske statsmedier.** *Zenodo*. doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.7125103

### **Press (Danish)**

**2026 Messerschmidts comeback-maskine.** Politiken (March 2026).

**2026 Mona Juul er »stiktosset«: Billedfejl i Epstein-dækning kan forfølge hende.** Politiken (February 2026).

**2025 Michael Bang Petersen ser et behov for kaos. Jeg ser også et lukket system.** Politiken (December 2025).

**2024 Facebookgrupper er blevet dørmænd for den offentlige debat.** Op-ed, Politiken (October 2024, with E. Mayerhöffer and J. B. Kristensen).

**2022 Censurerede russiske medier skulle skabe splid i Vesten, viser dansk undersøgelse.** Press release, multiple outlets (October 2022, with E. Mayerhöffer, T. Ramsland, J. B. Kristensen).

### **Funding and Proposal Work**

**2026 IKH Early Career Grant (50,000 DKK; applied).** Pilot project: data donation platform for AI-mediated communication research.

**2024 DFF proposal (co-authored):** Understanding party organisational routines and knowledge utilisation in parliament. *PI Jesper Dahl Kelstrup; WP1 computational design, data strategy, and methods writing.*

### **Academic Service**

**2023–2024** Board member, PhD Committee, Department of Communication and Arts, Roskilde University.

**2023** Member of working group on organisational policies, Roskilde University.

Peer reviewer: Information, Communication & Society; Media, War & Conflict; New Media and Society; Policy & Internet; Popular Communication.

### **Memberships and Affiliations**

- Digital Media Lab, Department of Communication and Arts, RUC (member since 2021; acting head of tech, 2024)
- Research group: Digital Publics and Trust, DCA, RUC
- Research group: Journalism and Democracy, DCA, RUC
- Centre for Digital Citizenship, RUC
- EU Knowledge Hub on Prevention of Radicalisation (appointed academic expert, 2025)
- Digi4Hum team, RUC (appointed 2026, technical support)

### **Awards and Scholarships**

**2025** Teaching Prize, Digital Media Lab, Roskilde University (team award; DKK 25,000).

**2014** Knud Højgaards Fond (university exchange stipend).

**2014** Oticon Fond (university exchange stipend).

### **External Engagement and Invited Presentations**

**2026** Keynote speaker (invited), Northern Star Symposium, Bodø.

**2025** Workshop on digital methods, University of Southern Denmark.

**2025** Presentation at Center for Tracking and Society, University of Copenhagen.

**2025** Seminar on online extremism, counterpublics, and conspiracy theories, University of Copenhagen.

**2024** Russian disinformation before and during the European election 2024, Moderaterne.

**2023** Making use of AI and large language models, Norion Consult.

**2023** Computational Communication Science Lab, University of Vienna.

### **Conference Presentations (selected)**

**2026** ICA (76th), Cape Town | ADD Academic Conference: Controversies of AI Society

**2025** Nordmedia, Odense | AOIR, Rio de Janeiro | Simulated Societies, Siena | COMPTXT (7th), Vienna

**2024** ECREA (11th), Ljubljana | Democracy & Digital Citizenship (2nd), Odense | ECPR General Conference, Dublin | ICA (74th), Gold Coast | Political Ecologies of the Far Right (2nd), Uppsala

**2023** ICA (73rd), Toronto | Technology in Movement, Copenhagen | Researching the Far-Right, Vienna

**2022** ECREA (9th), Aarhus | IJPP Conference (8th), Loughborough | ICA (72nd), Paris | Democracy & Digital Citizenship (1st), Roskilde | Media and Publics (1st), Roskilde (presenter and session chair)

### **Media Appearances and Public Engagement**

**2024** Det Politiske Mødested: Er Europa rustet til at modstå Putins troldehær. *Panel (April 2024).*

**2022** Forsker: Ingen stærke tegn på russisk indblanding i valgkamp. *Interview, Ritzau/Berlingske (October 2022).*

### **Skills and Languages**

Languages: Danish (native), English (fluent).

Computational: Python, R, PostgreSQL; Hugging Face (Transformers).

Methods: NLP / text-as-data, network analysis, surveys, agent-based modelling; mixed methods.

Tools: Gephi, NetLogo, 4CAT; UCloud; Office; AI tools.

### **References**

**Eva Mayerhöffer** (Associate Professor), Roskilde University [evamay@ruc.dk](mailto:evamay@ruc.dk)

**Jannie Møller Hartley** (Full Professor), Roskilde University [jath@ruc.dk](mailto:jath@ruc.dk)

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